

Singer of Life

Text: From a Texcoco Nahuatl poem

Music: Plains Indian traditional, 1879

LACQUIPARLE irregular

The musical score is written on a single staff in 2/2 time, with a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing rests. The lyrics are written below the staff, with line numbers 1 and 2 indicating different parts of the poem. Chords are indicated by Cm (C minor) and Fm (F minor) above the staff, with guitar fingering diagrams (x for natural, iii for third finger) provided for each. The score is divided into three systems, each with a Cm and Fm chord diagram. The lyrics are: 1 Sing - er of Life, all flow - ers are songs, with pet - als do you write. 2 Mor - tal are we, with all liv - ing things, with ea - gles in the sky. Sing - er of Life, you col - or the earth, daz - zling the eye with birds red and bright. E - ven all gold and jade will not last; sing - ing a - lone, I know, can - not die. Joy is for us! The flow - ers are spread! Sing - ing is our de - light! Here in this house of spring - time be - stow songs that like birds can fly.

Cm Fm Cm

1 Sing - er of Life, all flow - ers are songs, with pet - als do you write.
2 Mor - tal are we, with all liv - ing things, with ea - gles in the sky.

Cm Fm Cm

Sing - er of Life, you col - or the earth, daz - zling the eye with birds red and bright.
E - ven all gold and jade will not last; sing - ing a - lone, I know, can - not die.

Cm Fm Cm

Joy is for us! The flow - ers are spread! Sing - ing is our de - light!
Here in this house of spring - time be - stow songs that like birds can fly.